



The most cited paper on Wikipedia

A paper on climate classification has been referenced 2.8 million times on Wikipedia, due to its wide relevance. <https://dgit.in/jun18-A49-1>

for a variation of smart home devices, some examples being Philips Hue and Belkin's WeMo. Despite these affiliations, if you feel that Alexa is lacking, you enlist the help of IFTTT yet again. IFTTT boasts a channel for the Amazon Alexa, just as with Google Assistant, and can assist you in getting more out of your voice assistant. For this, you will need to connect your Amazon device to your home Wi-Fi network and initiate the 'Amazon Alexa' IFTTT channel. You can also start creating 'recipes' or applets using the 'if this, then that' approach.

IFTTT supercharges the smart home assistant's functionality by allowing it to control almost every smart device in your home. Amazon Alexa also works congruously with Android devices, Android Wear, Dropbox, iOS Photos, iOS Reminders and more. Alexa is able to transcend the boundaries and turn itself into a multi-faceted voice assistant that can integrate various parts of the users' lives.



IFTTT allows you to unleash a horde of functionalities to your voice assistants.

Another way to supercharge your Alexa device is delving into the complex world of developer tools, which requires some coding. But hey, if you are enthusiastic about it, go ahead! Amazon offers its users developer tools access and also gives step-by-step instructions for creating skills for Alexa. A variety of coding languages can be used like Python, Java, Node.js and more. You can find out more about this here (<https://dgit.in/skillsalexa>). For all those who are skeptical of delving into the world of coding, another simpler option, launched in the US, could be an option for everyone soon, created by the good ole' folks over at Amazon.

Amazon recently launched 'Alexa Blueprints', a new way to custom create and develop skills for Alexa and this variant doesn't require any coding knowledge. Alexa Blueprints users can create their own voice apps, develop Trivia games and also teach Alexa how to answer quirky questions. Steve Rabuchin, VP of Amazon Alexa said, "You don't need experience building skills or coding to get started."



SIRI

Siri, unfortunately, doesn't have a personalised IFTTT channel, which makes supercharging your iPhone voice assistant rather challenging. Still, you can do a few things within the app itself, that are either not universally known or deactivated by default, to make your Siri experience smoother and more streamlined. A pressing issue with Siri is the app often being unable to magically spring to life when the user says its trigger words. Bummer. However, the app does provide you with the ability to retrain your activation voice. Tip: Try to retrain the trigger words at a considerable distance from the phone, so Siri can efficiently recognise your voice even when you're not directly in front of your device. Siri often shies away from activating third-party integration automatically and most times, you will need to visit the settings of an app like Uber or Lyft and activate Siri search suggestions and usage yourself.

Another lesser known feature is phonetic contact names and being able to correct Siri when it pronounces a contact name on your device incorrectly. Simply tell Siri, "that's not how you say/pronounce it" when it incorrectly blurts out a name and Siri will ask for the correct pronunciation.

Go ahead and try out these tips and tricks that you can utilise to supercharge your current voice assistants. The technological world is certainly bringing us closer to our ultimate voice assistants needs, but until it reaches its zenith, these tips and tricks can keep the dream alive.



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